FREE SAMPLE



No Contact SOS Kit

Ten-minute steps for the moments you most want to check, text or call

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Read this before you start

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SOS card 1

You have one of six cards

Read this before you start

⚠ **IMPORTANT**

This kit gives you practical steps for specific moments. It is not therapy, medical advice or a safety plan, and it cannot replace a professional.

Get help from a person, not from a PDF, if any of these is true:

- You haven't slept or eaten properly for several days.
- You feel you cannot cope, or you think about harming yourself.
- You are afraid of the other person, or the relationship was abusive.

Where to call (United States)

- Emergency: **911**
- Suicide and mental health crisis: **988** (call, text or chat)
- Relationship violence: National Domestic Violence Hotline **1-800-799-7233**, or text **START** to **88788**
- Spain: 112 (emergency), 024 (suicide prevention), 016 (violence against women; it does not take calls from men: if you are a man, call 112 or go to a Victim Assistance Office).

If you are not in the U.S. or Spain, look up the emergency and crisis line for your country.

You may have ended the relationship, or the other person may have ended it. You may want them back, or you may feel relief.

This kit does not assume which one is you, and it does not promise any outcome with the other person. It helps you handle the moments when the urge is strongest.

YOUR STARTING POINT · 2 MINUTES

1. Who ended it?

2. Do you share work, friends, a home or children with them?

3. What time of day is hardest?

CHAPTER 3

SOS 1: The urge to check their socials

USE THIS WHEN

Your thumb is already heading toward their profile, or you just closed the app and feel the pull to open it again.

Read "The ten-minute plan" first. The explanation is at the end.

The ten-minute plan

> **You do not have to win forever. You have to get through the next ten minutes.**

1. **Put the phone face down, out of arm's reach.** Better: walk to another room. Start a timer for ten minutes on something that is not the phone (a kitchen timer, a watch, the oven clock).

2. **Change your body.** Stand up. Drink a full glass of water. Roll your shoulders. It takes one minute and gets you out of the scrolling posture.

3. **Write one line on the trigger sheet:** the time, the place, and what happened right before. "11:40 p.m., bed, a friend posted dinner photos." Nothing more.

4. **Do one thing from your swap list** (you build it further down). No screens.

5. **When the timer rings, rate the urge from 0 to 10.** Lower than before? Write the number down. Still high? Start another ten minutes. There is no limit on how many rounds you can do.

EXERCISE

Read the five steps once more and say them out loud. You will not remember them when the urge hits, so the card at the end of this chapter exists. Save it to your phone's favorites now.

What it looks like at 11:40 p.m.

Imagine a Tuesday. You are in bed, lamp off. A friend you share with your ex posted photos from a birthday dinner. You tell yourself you will only check whether they were there.

Three minutes later you are on a profile you haven't opened in a week. You are reading the comments under a photo and zooming into the background of the picture. At 12:15 you feel worse than at 11:40, and sleep is further away.

Now the same night with the plan. The urge arrives at 11:40 anyway. You notice your thumb.

You get out of bed, walk to the kitchen, start the timer, drink the water, and write the line on the sheet. You wash the two mugs in the sink, because that was on your swap list. At minute ten the urge is a 6 instead of an 8. You start another ten. By 12:05 it is a 3. You go back to bed without having looked.

This is an imagined example, not a guarantee. Some nights the urge stays high for three rounds. The plan is the same on those nights.

EXERCISE

Write down your own version of 11:40 p.m. What is the moment, what is the app?

Before the urge: make it harder

It is much easier to beat the urge when the app takes effort to open.

> **Do this once, today, when you are calm.**

Start with reversible steps.

- **Move the app off your home screen.** Put it in a folder on the last page.
- **Log out of it.** Do not save the password. Typing it in is a pause.
- **Mute their account, their stories and their posts.** Check in each app whether they are notified when you mute. Muting is easy to undo later; blocking is a bigger step.
- **Mute the side doors.** Tagged photos, mutual friends' stories, the "people you may know" list. It is easy to end up on the profile by a detour.

- **Set a daily time limit for the app** using the screen-time feature your phone has, if it has one (look in Settings). If your phone allows a passcode for that limit, ask someone you trust to set it.

TIP

If muting isn't enough, unfollow or block. Do it for yourself, not as a message to them.

EXERCISE

Do at least three of these five right now. Write down which ones.

Your swap list

> **When the urge hits, you won't want to invent something to do. So you decide now.**

Write five things that meet three rules: no screen, no other person needed, and you can start in under a minute. Examples:

- Take a shower, even if it's the middle of the afternoon.
- Walk to the end of the block and back.
- Wash the dishes or empty the dishwasher.
- If you have the energy, do twenty squats or ten push-ups.
- Record a voice memo to yourself saying what you feel. Do not send it to anyone.
- Write one full page by hand about what you are avoiding looking at.

If you have nobody to call right now, that is exactly why this list needs to be about things you can do alone.

EXERCISE

Write your five. Put the easiest one first.

If you looked anyway

It can happen.

> **Looking does not cancel the work you did before.**

1. Close the app. Don't scroll "just to finish."
2. Write down what you looked at, for how long, and how you feel from 0 to 10.
3. Do not punish yourself with a longer list of rules. Punishing yourself tends to keep the loop going.
4. Start the ten-minute timer now, as if it were a fresh urge.
5. Mark the row as "looked" on your trigger sheet. The sheet counts looks. It does not count shame.

TIP

If you looked five times today, that is information. Go back to the "make it harder" list and add one more step.

EXERCISE

Write the sentence you will say to yourself after a slip. Short, flat, not harsh.

When you can't cut it off completely

Pick the case that fits you.

- **You see them at work or share a group chat.** You cannot mute your whole workplace. Mute what you can, and check Chapter 12 (when you can't avoid them) in the full kit. For now, the rule is: what you choose to look at is yours, even if their name appears in your day.
- **They ended it and asked you not to insist.** You may not feel like you are "doing no contact" at all, because you didn't choose it. This chapter still

works. Not checking is a choice you make for your own evenings.

- **The relationship was harmful or unsafe.** You might feel relief and still have the urge to look, or you might have no urge at all. Both happen. If you are checking their profile to know where they are or whether you are safe, that is a safety question. Use the numbers on the first page and talk to someone.

EXERCISE

Circle the case that fits you, and note one change that follows from it.

Why ten minutes (the short explanation)

My working hypothesis behind this chapter: checking may give a quick bit of relief and then leave you feeling worse, which makes you want to check again.

You may notice that the urge comes in waves rather than staying at one level. Ten minutes is short enough to bear and may be long enough for the first peak to drop.

This is a working assumption, not a clinical claim and not a proven fact. Your trigger sheet will tell you whether it holds for you. After three days, look at your numbers.

EXERCISE

On day 3, read your trigger sheet and answer: at minute 10, was the urge lower than at minute 0?

Today's checklist

- [ ] Three "make it harder" steps done
- [ ] Swap list written
- [ ] SOS card saved to your phone
- [ ] First row of the trigger sheet filled in, even if it is a practice row

Today: urges, times I looked

Day	Urges (0-10)	Times I looked
Day 1		
Day 2		
Day 3		
Day 4		
Day 5		
Day 6		
Day 7		

SOS card 1

SOS 1

The urge to check their socials

1. Phone face down, out of reach. Timer: 10 min.
2. Stand up. Drink a glass of water.
3. Write one line: time, place, what just happened.
4. Do one thing from your swap list.
5. Timer rings: rate the urge 0-10. Still high? Another 10.

You looked? Note it, restart the timer. Not a failure.

No Contact SOS Kit

You have one of six cards

This sample covers one moment. The full kit covers six:

1. **The urge to check their socials**
2. Before you hit send
3. They texted me
4. I broke no contact
5. Nights and mornings
6. The weekend

It also includes a 30-day tracker, five fill-in templates, and printable and editable versions of everything.

TO PRINT

The trigger sheet, the weekly review, the 7-day tracker and the SOS card are in the "printable" file of this sample.